

# MICHAEL (MIKE) GIBSON

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Last Update: November 2024  
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## EDUCATION

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Ph.D. in Agricultural and Resource Economics<br>University of Maryland, College Park | May 2027 (expected) |
| M.S. in Agricultural and Resource Economics<br>University of Maryland, College Park  | May 2025            |
| M.S. in Economics<br>Tufts University                                                | May 2018            |
| B.A. in Economics,<br>Wheaton College (Massachusetts)                                | May 2016            |

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## RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics, Agricultural Economics, Applied Microeconomics

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## WORKING PAPERS

*Manuscripts may be available at [mtgibson.github.io](https://mtgibson.github.io); selected paper abstracts are available at the end.*

1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

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## WORKS IN PROGRESS

1. **Gibson, M.** “When Improving Agricultural Productivity Helps or Hurts: Sectoral Correlation and Growth Effects of Productivity Shocks”
2. **Gibson, M.** “Harvesting the Toll: Productivity Loss from Suicide in U.S. Agriculture [Joint with Ariel Listo]”

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## TECHNICAL WRITING

1. “[Introduction to randomized evaluations](#)” (Joint with Anja Sautmann, contributions from Laura Feeney and Claire Walsh) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
2. “[The elements of a randomized evaluations](#)” (Joint with Anja Sautmann, contributions from Laura Feeney and Claire Walsh) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
3. “[Survey programming](#)” (Joint with Wim Louw, contributions from Kathryn McDermott) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
4. “[Data quality checks](#)” (Contributions from Ben Morse) Jameel Poverty Action Lab
5. “[Implementation monitoring](#)” (Contributions from Arnesh Chowdhury, Maya Duru, Lipika Kapoor, Sarah Kopper, Wim Louw, Tithee Mukhopadhyay, and Clare Sachsse) Jameel Poverty Action Lab

6. [“Resources for conducting remote surveys”](#) (Joint with Sarah Kopper, contributions from Marifatul Amalia, Saurabh Bhajibhakare, Putul Gupta, and Wim Louw) Jameel Poverty Action Lab

## INVITED TALKS

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1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

Institute for Humane Studies (IHS) 2024 Winter Graduate Seminars

2024

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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1. **Gibson, M.** “Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán”

Western Economic Association International 99th Annual Conference, Seattle

2024

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Strategic Impact Evaluation Fund (SIEF) Fellow, World Bank

Dr. Alaka Holla & Dr. Anja Sautmann

Jun. 2023 - current

### Research Assistant, University of Maryland

Dr. Erik Lichtenberg & Dr. Lars Olson

Dec. 2023 - Sept 2024

Dr. Lori Lynch

May. 2022 - Jun. 2023

### Masters Thesis, Tufts University

Dr. Melissa McInerney

Sept. 2017 - May 2018

[Contingency Plans: The Effects of Dependent Coverage Mandate on the Contingent Workforce Decisions of Young Adults](#)

### Research Assistant, Tufts University

Dr. Jenny Aker

Sept. 2017 - May 2018

[Harvesting the rain: The adoption of environmental technologies in the Sahel](#)

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### Teaching Assistant, University of Maryland, College Park

*Undergraduate-level*

AREC 241: Environment, Economics and Policy;

Fall 2024

Dr. Lars Olson

AREC 280: Big Data and Climate Change;

Fall 2023

Dr. Lars Olson

ECON/AREC 481: Environmental Economics; rating: **3.5/4** (N=7)

Spring 2022

Dr. Robertson Williams, III

AREC 240: Introduction to Environmental Economics; rating: **3.4/4** (N=17)

Spring 2022

Dr. Robertson Williams, III

AREC 365: World Hunger, Population, and Food; rating: **3.3/4** (N=3)  
Dr. Ken Leonard

Fall 2021

### Head Teaching Assistant, Tufts University

*Undergraduate-level*

EC 05: Introduction to Economics

Fall 2017, Spring 2018

### Teaching Assistant, Tufts University

*Undergraduate-level*

EC 05: Introduction to Economics

Fall 2016, Spring 2017

### Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, Wheaton College (Massachusetts)

Macroeconomics I

Spring 2015

## AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

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|                                                                       |      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Bessie H. DeVault Best Prospectus Award, University of Maryland, AREC | 2025 |
| Paper Accelerator Grant, (\$5,000) Institute for Humane Studies       | 2023 |
| Dean's Fellowship, University of Maryland                             | 2021 |

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Reviewer, American Journal of Agricultural Economics                     | 2025-            |
| Graduate Representative for AREC, University of Maryland , College Park  | 2023, 2024       |
| Graduate Student Government Member, University of Maryland, College Park | 2023, 2024       |
| Global Applications International Network Mentor                         | 2021, 2022, 2024 |

## LANGUAGE AND SKILLS

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Language: English (native), Spanish (intermediate), French (beginner)  
Software: Stata, R, MATLAB, ArcGIS,  $\text{\LaTeX}$

## SELECTED ABSTRACTS

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1. **Gibson, M.** "Do natural resource booms lead to resource curses? The impact of avocado export restrictions on Michoacán"

This paper documents the joint impacts of an export restriction and anti-drug trafficking policy on municipalities in avocado-producing states. I show theoretically that the policies could increase the profitability of avocado production in municipalities but expose them to cartel exploitation. Using a difference-in-difference approach, I show that after the policies are enacted, high-suitability municipalities expand avocado production yet experience only short-term income benefits. Consistent with the model, these municipalities are roughly 24% more likely to face cartel occupation after the policies are enacted. I rule out several alternative explanations and mechanisms for the lack of long-term benefits.